

WHAT WE DID TOGETHER

Start small. Learn fast.

This was a working session, not a lecture. Together we took the AI question, the one that feels equal parts opportunity and noise, and brought it down to something you can act on Monday: one small experiment, run by your own team, that teaches you something fast. Here is what we covered, so you can run the same thinking with your people.

The idea: a safe-to-fail pilot

Most AI efforts stall because they start too big and too vague. A safe-to-fail pilot is the opposite. It is one task, bounded tightly, with a person in charge and a decision date set before you begin. You are not betting the business. You are buying a lesson. Some pilots work and you keep them. Some do not, and they cost you a little time and teach you a lot. Either way you come out ahead, and the next one is easier.

The three moves

- 01 Frame.** Write the idea as a pilot: one task, a hard boundary, a plain statement of what you want. If you cannot bound it, it is not ready yet.
- 02 Pressure-test.** Pick the idea apart for what could go wrong, then rebuild it stronger. The trick is to attack the idea, never the person, which is easiest on a case that belongs to nobody in the room.
- 03 Order.** Weigh the payoff against the time it takes. A simple read, value divided by time-to-value, shows where to look first. You still make the call.

You know your business better than any number does. The score points the flashlight. You decide where to walk.

THE WHOLE METHOD, IN ONE LINE

What you saw

We ran two real cases from your world. The first was a drafting assistant for RFIs, submittals, and change orders on one project, with the PM editing and sending every item. High value, fast to learn from, so the flashlight pointed there first. The second helped an estimator with takeoff and first-pass scope on a single bid. Just as valuable, arguably more, but plans are messy and the stakes are higher, so it takes longer to trust and waits its turn. That contrast is the lesson: high value alone does not win. Value over time does.

Run it again with your team

- Pick one task your team does often, the repetitive, text-heavy kind where a miss is easy to catch.
- Frame it on the worksheet: the task, a hard boundary, the one outcome you want.
- Pressure-test it with your people. Welcome the hard questions. That is where weak ideas get stronger.
- Read value against time, set a thirty-day decision date, and name the person who owns it.
- At day thirty, decide plainly: scale it, adjust it, or stop. Then start the next one.

Bring it back to your group

This is where Study Groups does what it has always done. Run a pilot, then bring what you learned to your next meeting. Compare notes with peers who face the same pressures, benchmark what worked, and borrow what worked for them. One pilot run alone is a useful rep. One pilot shared across the group is how a whole industry learns faster than its competitors. That is the point of the room you are already in.

One pilot is one rep. The goal is not the task. It is the muscle, yours and your group's, to run the next ten with confidence.
